

IELTS Writing Task 1 Charts Pack

Book 2 of 5 · Describe Academic graphs clearly and accurately

Stratum IELTS · stratumielts.com

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Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

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How to use this book

1. Learn the report skeleton (4 parts).
2. Practise selecting only key data.
3. Use the language banks for trends and comparisons.
4. Write one timed Task 1 (20 minutes), then check feedback at stratumielts.com.

This guide is for **Academic Task 1** (graphs, charts, tables, diagrams, maps).

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1. What Task 1 asks for

In Academic Writing Task 1 you summarise visual information in **at least 150 words** in about **20 minutes**.

You should:

- paraphrase the question
- select key features (not every number)
- make clear comparisons
- stay factual (no personal opinion)

20-minute plan

Time	Action
0–3	Understand the chart + choose 2–3 key features
3–17	Write overview + details
17–20	Check numbers, tenses, and word count

2. The 4-part report

1. **Introduction** — paraphrase what the chart shows
2. **Overview** — 2–3 main trends / biggest differences (no small details)
3. **Detail paragraph A** — first group of data
4. **Detail paragraph B** — second group / remaining comparisons

Do not copy the question word-for-word.

Do not give reasons like “because people like...”. Task 1 is description, not opinion.

Mini outline

Overview point 1: _____

Overview point 2: _____

Detail group A: _____

Detail group B: _____

3. Chart types and focus

Line graph

Focus on start/end, peaks, falls, periods of stability.

Bar chart

Focus on highest/lowest categories and clear gaps.

Pie chart

Focus on largest/smallest shares and notable contrasts.

Table

Group related rows/columns; highlight extremes and patterns.

Process diagram

Describe stages in order; use sequence language (*first, then, after that, finally*).

Map

Describe changes over time or differences between locations (*north of, adjacent to, converted into*).

Selection rule: if a number does not support a key feature, skip it.

4. Language banks

Introduction starters

- The chart illustrates...
- The graph compares...
- The table provides information about...
- The diagram shows the process of...

Overview starters

- Overall, ...
- It is clear that...
- The most noticeable feature is...

Upward movement

- rose / increased / grew / climbed
- a sharp rise / a gradual increase
- roughly doubled / nearly tripled

Downward movement

- fell / declined / dropped / decreased

- a slight fall / a dramatic decline

Stability / fluctuation

- remained stable / stayed roughly the same
- fluctuated / varied

Comparison

- higher than / lower than
- the largest proportion
- similarly / by contrast
- while X ..., Y ...

Approximate numbers

- about / around / approximately / just under / just over

Use past tense for finished past periods, present for timeless processes/maps described as current.

5. Sample report (original)

Task

The line graph below shows the number of public library visits (in thousands) in a city from 2010 to 2020.

(Imagine a graph: 2010 = 40; 2012 = 55; 2014 = 50; 2016 = 70; 2018 = 85; 2020 = 80.)

Report

The line graph illustrates how many times people visited public libraries in one city between 2010 and 2020, with figures given in thousands.

Overall, library visits increased over the period despite a small mid-decade dip and a slight fall at the end. The strongest growth occurred after 2014.

In 2010, visits stood at 40 thousand. They rose to 55 thousand by 2012, then declined slightly to 50 thousand in 2014. After that point, the upward trend became clearer: visits climbed to 70 thousand in 2016 and reached a peak of 85 thousand in 2018.

In the final two years, the figure fell modestly to 80 thousand in 2020. Even so, this was still double the 2010 starting point, confirming a substantial long-term increase in library use.

Why this works

- Clear paraphrase + overview
- Key numbers only

- Logical time order
- Comparisons without opinion

6. Practice tasks

For each prompt, write 150+ words in 20 minutes.

1. **Bars:** Compare energy use in five household categories in two years.
2. **Pies:** Show the share of transport types used by students in 2015 and 2025.
3. **Table:** Average weekly screen time by age group over three years.
4. **Process:** Describe how recycled paper is produced (5–7 stages).
5. **Map:** A town centre in 2000 and 2020 — shops, roads, park changes.

After writing, ask:

- Did I include an overview?
- Did I avoid listing every number?
- Are comparisons clear?

7. Next step

- Essay structure → **Book 1**
- Better wording for essays → **Book 3**
- Typical Task 1 errors → **Book 4**
- Final checks → **Book 5**

Then submit your report to the **Stratum IELTS Writing checker** at <https://stratumielts.com>.

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